To publish academic papers using GitHub so they are indexable by **Google Search** or **Google Scholar**, you need to configure your repository correctly. Google Scholar does not crawl standard markdown repositories or code, but it **does crawl public PDFs and web pages** that follow specific academic metadata rules.

Here is how you can use GitHub to ensure Google indexes your papers.

Phase 1: Publishing for Google Scholar (Academic Indexing)

Google Scholar finds papers by crawling websites and looking for PDFs accompanied by proper bibliographic metadata. Because it cannot directly index a GitHub repository as a standard citable publication, you must use **GitHub Pages** to host a webpage for your paper. Academia Stack Exchange

1. Host the Paper on GitHub Pages

1. Create a public repository on GitHub.
2. Add your paper as a **PDF file** to the repository (e.g., `my-paper.pdf`).
3. Enable **GitHub Pages** in your repository settings (`Settings` -> `Pages`) so your repository builds into a public website (e.g., `https://github.io`). GitHub

2. Create an `index.html` File with Academic Metadata

Google Scholar relies on specific HTML header tags (`citation_` tags) to extract metadata like authors, titles, and publication dates. Place an `index.html` file in the root of your GitHub repository containing the following structure:

html

```html
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
  <meta charset="utf-8">
  <title>Your Paper Title Here</title>

  <!-- Critical Google Scholar Metadata Tags -->
  <meta name="citation_title" content="Your Paper Title Here">
  <meta name="citation_author" content="Author, Firstname">
  <meta name="citation_author" content="Coauthor, Secondname">
  <meta name="citation_publication_date" content="2026/10/21">
```

```
  <meta name="citation_online_date" content="2026/10/21">

  <!-- Points directly to the raw PDF file hosted on your GitHub Pages -->
  <meta name="citation_pdf_url" content="https://github.io">
</head>
<body>
  <h1>Your Paper Title Here</h1>
  <p>By Firstname Author and Secondname Coauthor</p>
  <p><strong>Abstract:</strong> Your paper abstract goes here...</p>
  <a href="my-paper.pdf">Download Full PDF</a>
</body>
</html>
```

Use code with caution.

Note: Once this page is live and linked from somewhere else on the web, Google Scholar's automated crawler will eventually find the metadata and add the PDF to its index.

Phase 2: Publishing for Standard Google Search

If you want your GitHub codebase, documentation, or paper repository to show up quickly in general **Google Web Search** results, you can bypass waiting for Google to organically crawl it by manually requesting an index. GitHub +1

1. **Verify Ownership:** Go to the Google Search Console.
2. **Add Property:** Select "URL prefix" and enter your GitHub Pages URL (e.g., `https://github.io`).
3. **Upload Verification File:** Download the HTML verification file provided by Google, upload it to the root of your GitHub repository, and push it live.
4. **Request Indexing:** Once verified in Search Console, paste your exact paper URL into the "URL Inspection" tool and click **Request indexing**. GitHub